Ontario province, four from British Columbia, three from Alberta and one from Quebec. Out of the thirty-seven members of Prime Minister Justin Trudeau's cabinet, four are of Punjabi origin – three Sikhs and one Hindu (Anita Anand). Three Sikhs had been members of Trudeau's previous cabinet, including Defence Minister Harjit Singh Sajjan. This time, Trudeau's Liberal Party could get only 157 seats, thirteen short of an absolute majority, and the main opposition Conservative Party won 121 seats. The fourth largest party, the New Democratic Party, led by Jagmeet Singh, a Sikh lawyer, secured twenty-four seats.

Ghadar Party and Komagata Maru

Two developments of the early twentieth century – the founding of the Ghadar (rebellion) Party in San Francisco in 1913 and the Komagata Maru incident of 1914 – require special mention here because of their respective roles in India's freedom movement and in addressing some of the problems faced by contemporary Punjabi/Sikh settlers in Canada.

The Ghadar Party, initially called the Pacific Coast Hindustan Association, was formed in 1913 in the US at Yughantar Ashram, San Francisco, with Sohan Singh Bhakna as its president. The members of the party were largely Sikhs, including some from Vancouver. Some of its members were also students at the University of California at Berkeley, including Har Dayal, Tarak Nath Das, Maulvi Barkatullah, Harnam Singh Tundilat and V.G. Pingle. The party quickly gained support from Indian expatriates, especially in the US, Canada, east Africa and Asia.

The movement was built around the weekly journal *Ghadar* , first edited by Lala Hardayal and later by seventeen-year-old Kartar Singh Sarabha. Its first issue dated 1 November 1913 was in Urdu. The one in Punjabi started from 9 December in the same year. The *Ghadar* of 11 August 1914 gave on its title page, the following audacious call of urgency to fellow Ghadarites 'Wanted – Fearless, Courageous Soldiers for spreading Mutiny in India; Salary – Death; Award – Martyrdom & Freedom; Place – The Battlefield India'. [5] The ideology of the party was secular. In the words of Sohan Singh